ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	37th Commission Meeting
DATE:	25 September, 2026
TIME:	09:30 AM
VENUE:	Druk Dradhir Khang

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSIONS	DECISIONS
1	**Apprise on a grievance on Integrity Vetting Report issued – CFD, DoPS** The grievance was submitted by the former CEO of the National Cottage and Small Industry Development Bank Ltd., concerning the 'provisional record' against him in the Integrity Vetting System (IVS). The record emanated from Case No. 12/2022 (Part III) relating to the proposal for establishment of a face-mask production unit. It was apprised that the OAG had dropped the criminal charges against him and two others. However, based on the findings relating to supervisory accountability, the Commission had decided to take an administrative action against him. Before the administrative action could be implemented, he had already exited the system. Consequently, the administrative action could not be taken and the matter was decided to be retained in the IVS. The former CEO, however, contested that he was not directly involved in the alleged wrongdoing. He further submitted that, during the ACC's investigations, he had been interviewed only as a witness and had not subsequently been informed of such implication. Further, it was apprised that there are around 22 other individuals who have similarly exited the system while administrative action remained pending, with their record continuing to be maintained in the IVS. The records relate to cases of differing nature and degree of accountability. On the other hand, it was noted that removing the names of persons from the IVS merely because they have left the system, without formally concluding or addressing the underlying matter, could create accountability concerns.	The Commission decided that the record against the former CEO shall be retained in the IVS. However, DoPS was directed to communicate to him that the record was based on administrative action decided against him for supervisory accountability and his role in the collective decision making. At the same time, the Commission directed DoPS and LD to; (i) verify the factual account of the case and issues based on which the former CEO was implicated. (ii) review and revise the relevant provisions of the rules to address the identified grey areas. In doing so, IVR should primarily serve as a statement of facts, informing the concerned agency of the existence and status of the matter. The revised provisions should have clear parameters to deal with such cases consistently rather than relying on a case-by-case basis.

	To this, it was apprised that the existing provisions of the Integrity Vetting Rules (IVR) on provisional records do not clearly address such circumstances. A 'provisional record' is intended for pending investigation, ongoing investigation, pending administrative action, or pending trial, and is timebound; to eventually reach a conclusion. However, where an individual has resigned, retired, or otherwise left the system before the recommended administrative action is taken, the matter may remain indefinitely without a clear mechanism for closure. The Legal Division informed the Commission that, in line with the Commission's previous directives, the IVR/provisions are being reviewed and redrafted to address such situations.	
2	**Apprise Training Calendar for the FY 2026-2027 – HRS** The Commission was apprised of the HR Calendar adopted by the HRC, with a total training budget of Nu. 10.9 million, besides direct support under the GoI and ITEC courses. It was noted that Cellebrite training is also a priority but does not have adequate budget in the current financial year. The Commission also discussed available ITEC training opportunities and the need for coordination through the relevant government channel.	Considering the importance of building the capacity of existing staff, the Commission directed HRS to continue exploring the possibility of availing the Cellebrite training in Singapore, given that undertaking the training in the US would be comparatively expensive. With regard to ITEC courses, the Commission reiterated its earlier directive to coordinate with the MoFAET. The HRS was directed to formally write to MoFAET, informing them of the ACC's interest in exploring relevant ITEC training opportunities and requesting their facilitation with the Indian Embassy, as appropriate. A copy of the letter to be shared with the Chairperson.
3	**Apprise on First Resumed 17th Session of the Implementation Review Group (IRG) held from 31 August – 4 September 2026 at Vienna, Austria – SS** The Commission was apprised that the resumed session of IRG discussed progress of the UNCAC Implementation Review Mechanism, preparations for the second phase of country reviews, revisions to the self-assessment checklist and review schedule, digital solutions for the review process, budgetary matters, technical assistance, and thematic issues relating to criminalization and law enforcement. It was also noted that the second phase of the Review Mechanism is expected to commence in May 2027, with the remaining first-phase reviews targeted for completion by the end of 2027. *Copy of presentation attached as annexure 1.*	Updated and noted.

4	**Invitation for:** - **Second resumed 17th Session of the IRG from 2 – 5 November 2026;** - **15th open-ended Intergovernmental expert meeting for international cooperation & 20th session of the open-ended Intergovernmental working group on asset recovery from 3 – 5 November 2026;** - **Special session of the COSP to the UNCAC on 6 November 2026.** The Commission discussed that the dates coincide with the 108 Project Initiative in GMC, for which the Commission and most staff have registered to volunteer. Furthermore, the Commission was also apprised that after the HRD budget prioritisation and appropriation, the fund position did not look favourable in considering more than one participant.	The Commission decided not to participate in the meetings on this occasion, noting that the agendas did not include any significant matters requiring Bhutan's attention.
5	**Present proposed revisions in the Asset Declaration Rules 2022 – ADMD, DoPE & LD**	Deferred with a directive to schedule a separate dedicated session for detailed discussion.
6	**Apprise on 'Global Expert Meeting on Intelligent Tools for Anti-Corruption Agency (ACA) Effectiveness' held from 2 – 3 September 2026 in Ljubljana, Slovenia – ADMD, DoPE & PPD** The meeting was organized by the IACA in collaboration with the Commission for the Prevention of Corruption (KPK) of Slovenia. The meeting focussed on intelligent tools for corruption prevention; monitoring of national anti-corruption strategies; e-procurement; and asset disclosure management. Key follow-up areas identified included enhancing the Asset Declaration System through automation and risk-based verification; strengthening the Integrity Vetting System through AI-assisted analysis and system integration; embedding a robust digital monitoring and evaluation framework in the new anti-corruption strategy; developing predictive corruption-risk analysis under the EAD function; drawing on Slovenia and Ukraine's practices to strengthen conflict-of-interest management; explore relevance of Slovenia's ERAR experience for developing a lobbying mechanism; and Slovenia's experience to strengthen the ACC's whistleblower protection mechanism.	The Commission directed PPD to share the report with the Commission. * as well as public annual dashboard with AD statistics
7	**Apprise on 'European Conference on Measuring Anti-Corruption Agency Effectiveness' held from 16 – 18 September 2026 in Rome, Italy – PPD** It was apprised that the meeting was organized by IACA in collaboration with the Italian National Anti-Corruption Authority (ANAC) under IACA's Global Programme on Measuring Corruption.	The Commission decided to: • Explore Brazil's AI & data-analytics approach in public procurement. DoPE was directed to engage the PPMD of the Ministry of Finance and facilitate further discussion,

	Key practices identified for possible adaptation by the ACC included technology-assisted legislative corruption-risk review, integrated data analytics for proactive corruption prevention and detection, automated asset declaration and cross-verification, and specialized capability for cryptocurrency and virtual-asset investigations. The Commission was also informed that IACA had welcomed the ACC's interest in publishing Bhutan's IACA Effectiveness Assessment Report.	including possible online engagement with Ms. Tatiana. • Explore opportunities for practical training on cryptocurrency and virtual-asset investigations. PPD was directed to discuss with IACA/Mr. Drago and draw on relevant international experience, including that of Ukraine. • To publish Bhutan's IACA Effectiveness Assessment Report. Before publication, PPD was directed to confirm with IACA whether the revised assessment methodology is available, following which the Commission will determine the appropriate way forward.
8	**Apprise the proposed MOU with the Bhutan Transparency Initiative – PPD** The Commission was apprised of the proposed renewal of MoU with the BTI, for a period of five years. The MoU covers collaborations in the areas of corruption prevention and education, including the conduct of the National Corruption Barometer Survey (NCBS). It was noted that direct financing of the NCBS by the ACC could raise concerns regarding the independence and perceived impartiality of the survey process. The Commission also raised the question of benefits of such studies in the past. However, it was noted that such studies have already been projected and planned in the 13th FYP.	The Commission endorsed the draft MoU but directed to revise the validity to three years. To align with the Commission's tenure. With regards to signing of the MoU, PPD was directed to confirm the appropriate signatories. If the MoU is signed by the Chairman of the BTI Board, it shall be countersigned by the Chairperson of ACC but if signed by the ED of BTI, it shall be countersigned by the focal Commissioner.
9	**Apprise on the proposed bilateral meeting with the Corruption Prevention and Combating Bureau (KNAB) of Latvia – PPD** During the country's visit to Latvia for the peer review under UNCAC from 6–8 October 2026, the three nominated experts would also have an opportunity to engage with the KNAB. Based on the Commission's advice to maximize the visit, a bilateral meeting has been proposed for 9 October 2026 to learn from KNAB's experience in corruption prevention and investigation.	The Commission endorsed the additional day, on 9 October 2026, for the bilateral engagement with KNAB, considering it a valuable opportunity to learn from Latvia's experiences.
10	**Apprise on the invitation to the "Trust Summit: Nairobi Dialogue on global trust 2026" – PPD** The invitation was extended to the Chairperson by the State Department for Foreign Affairs, Ministry of Foreign and Diaspora Affairs, to attend the Submit in Nairobi from 21-23 October 2026.	The Commission declined this invitation.

	The Commission noted such a request was first of its kind and the agenda of the summit appeared to be general and broad not to mention the fact that the letter also mentioned nothing about the funding.	
11	**Apprise on the announcement of nominations for the 2026 Anti-Corruption Excellence Award (ACE Award) – PPD** It was apprised that the call for nominations for the 10th ACE Award 2026, covers five categories: Lifetime/Outstanding Achievement; Academic Research and Education; Innovation/Investigative Journalism; Youth Creativity and Engagement; and Safeguarding Sports from Corruption. The nomination is required to be made by a third party. It was noted that the ACC had previously participated under the Youth Creativity and Engagement category for Integrity Clubs initiative.	The Commission decided not to submit any nomination for the 2026 ACE Award.
12	**Any other:** The Head SS apprised the Commission on the following: • update on security deployment by the RBP to ACC in December 2026; • discussion with the MoIT on the possibility of their support for the conceptual design of the housing colony; and • the proposed passageway to the NLCS office and its canteen, not being advisable for security concerns.	The Commission directed SS to ascertain whether MoIT has the required capacity to undertake the conceptual design of the housing colony and report back to the Commission.

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**